

What is an idiom?

- An idiom is a word or phrase that means something different than you would think from the individual words.
- For example, what does “give up” mean?
 - Can you actually give something “up” (not “down”?)

A “piece of cake”



A. Soft

B. Easy

C. Really nice

D. Difficult

“Piece of cake” = Easy

- That spelling test was so easy I thought it was a piece of cake.

Icing on the cake



A. Yummy
C. Messy

B. A good thing added to another good thing
D. Easy to do

“Icing on the cake” = A good thing added to another good thing

- I was so happy that I scored three goals in the soccer game, but when I was also voted “most valuable player” it was just icing on the cake.

A wild goose chase



- A. A fast chase
- B. A slow chase
- C. A pointless or useless chase
- D. An animal chase

“A wild goose chase” = a chase that is pointless or useless

- Jack wanted to buy the new Super Mario game but it was sold out everywhere. He went on a wild goose chase to five different stores and came home empty-handed.

All in the same boat



All In The Same Boat - Oil on canvas 29" x 40" £2500

- A. A group traveling together B. People with the same problem
C. People who can't swim D. Unhappy people

“All in the same boat” =
people with the same
problem

- When the snowstorm closed the airport, we were all in the same boat, stuck at the airport with no way to leave.

Cold feet



A. People without shoes
C. To be brave, fearless

B. To lose your nerve
D. To act silly

“Cold feet” = To lose your nerve

- Sara was going to play the piano in the talent show, but then she got cold feet and was too afraid to enter the contest.

Raining cats and dogs



A. Raining heavily

B. Raining just a little

C. Something mysterious

D. Telling a joke

“Raining cats and dogs” =
Raining heavily

- I got really drenched when it started raining cats and dogs.

Pulling my leg



- A. Rough soccer play
- C. Shouting loudly

- B. Unfair actions
- D. To trick someone by saying something false

“Pulling my leg” = To trick
someone by saying
something false

- Did you really meet President Barack Obama or are you just pulling my leg?

Out of the woods



- A. Out of danger
- B. The end of a hike
- C. The end of a vacation
- D. A big city

“Out of the woods” = out of danger

- Mr. Bell is no longer in the intensive care unit in the hospital, but he's still very sick. He's not out of the woods yet.

Pick your brains



- A. Get advice from an expert
- B. To think hard
- C. Tell a joke
- D. Make a mistake

“Pick your brain” = Get advice from an expert

- You've been to Hawaii three times, but this will be my first trip. I'd like to pick your brain and find out where the best beaches are.

Hit the books



- A. Refuse to study
- C. Create a story

- B. To study hard
- D. To get angry

“Hit the books” = to study
hard

- I have a big math test tomorrow so I'm going to hit the books and study really hard.

Don't cry over spilled milk



- A. Your luck will change
- B. Bad things often happen to you
- C. Be more careful
- D. Something bad happened - now move on

“Don’t cry over spilled milk”
= Something bad happened -
now move on

- I'm sorry you didn't make the soccer team, but don't cry over spilled milk. If you keep practicing and working hard, I'm sure you will make the team next year!

Cut corners



- A. Make a fancy design
- B. To do something fast but sloppily
- C. To drive fast
- D. Play fairly

“Cut corners” = to do something fast but sloppily

- The roof fell in because the builder had cut corners and not used strong materials.

Snowed under



A. Have a lot of work to do
C. Freezing cold

B. Buried in snow
D. Sleepy

“Snowed under” = buried in work

- I wish I could go to the movies with you, but I have too much homework and am snowed under.

Go to pieces



A. To divide an object
C. To play a game

B. To lose control of your emotions
D. To hide

“Go to pieces” = to lose control of your emotions

- When Jimmy heard that he wasn't getting a new Wii game for his birthday, he started to go to pieces and began crying and wailing.

Out of this world



A. Extremely good
C. Far away

B. Mysterious
D. Crazy

“Out of this world” =
extremely good

- Lisa's mom makes tamales that are the best I ever tasted; they are just out of this world.

In a pickle



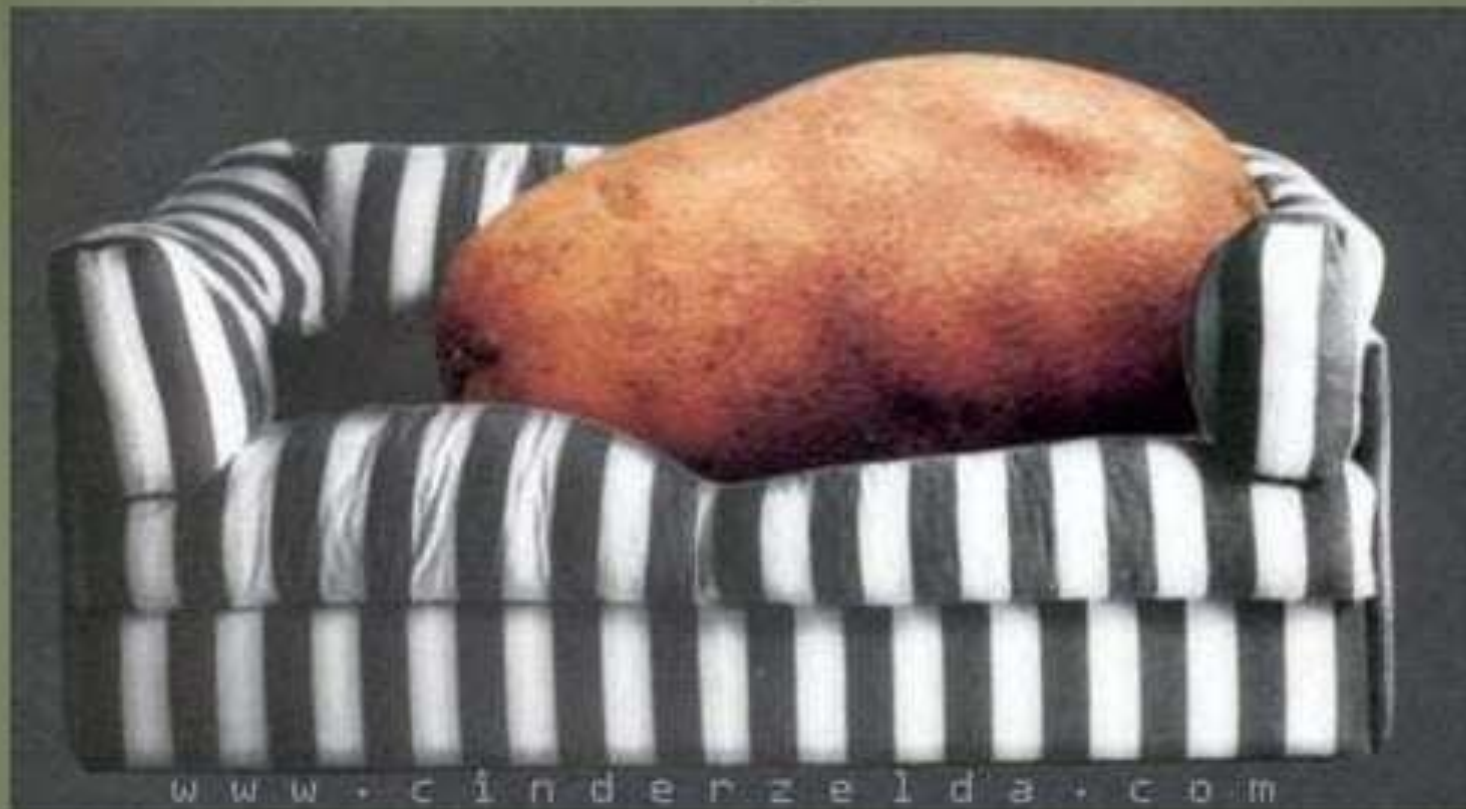
A. In trouble
C. Acting silly

B. Dressed in a costume
D. Angry

“In a pickle” = in trouble

- I came downtown on the bus but then I lost my wallet. I don't have money to buy a ticket back, and now I'm in a pickle.

Couch potato



- A. A lazy person who watches too much TV
- B. A pet that goes on furniture
- C. A person who tells jokes
- D. Food spilled on furniture

“Couch potato” = a lazy person who watches too much TV

- Freddy quit the soccer team. He has become a real couch potato and just stays home, plays video games, and watches TV.

Night owl



- A. A special bird
- B. A smart person
- C. A person who stays up late
- D. A burglar

“Night owl” = a person
who stays up late

- Isabel never goes to bed before midnight. She is a real night owl.

Off the top of your head



A. A special haircut
thinking about it first

B. To say something without
C. To hit someone from behind

D. Going out in cold weather without warm clothes

“Off the top of your head” =
to say something without
thinking about it first

- I know you haven't studied this yet but, just off the top of your head, what do you think were the causes of World War II?

Time on your hands



- A. Not enough to do
- B. A lazy person
- C. A person with two watches
- D. Someone who bends rules

“Time on your hands” =
not enough to do

- Since you have so much time on your hands and are not busy, why don't you learn to play the piano?

Wrapped up



A. Busy and involved with
C. To hear loud music

B. Hiding outside
D. Often absent

“Wrapped up” = busy and
involved with

- Rosa loves riding horses and taking care of them. She is so wrapped up in the horses that she never comes to play at my house anymore.

On the ball



- A. Good athletic skills
- B. With rounded edges
- C. Slow to understand
- D. Quick to understand•

“On the ball” = quick to understand

- Marta is really on the ball. She always does her homework, comes prepared to class, and pays close attention to the teacher.

An arm and a leg



A. Very expensive

B. Doing things twice

C. Bent over backwards

D. To save for later use

“An arm and a leg” = very
expensive

- I really wanted to get a new Xbox 360, but my parents said they cost an arm and a leg and we couldn't afford to buy one right now.